

WORKING DOCUMENT

Your Brand Launch Pack

Everyday clothing in Adire indigo, sold to the West African diaspora in the UK, US and Canada — positioning, profile copy, and the first nine posts.

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Figures for growth, timelines and prices in this document are planning estimates, not measured research. Test them against your own results and adjust.

Start here

Subject: a clothing brand selling to the West African diaspora in the UK, US and Canada. **Platforms:** Instagram + TikTok, Pinterest second. **Time:** 3–5 hrs/week.

FILE	WHAT IT IS
brand-foundation.md	Positioning, the name decision, where to manufacture, pricing, voice, palette, the product line
instagram-tiktok-copy.md	Handles, bios, highlights, pinned grid, shop page essentials
first-9-posts.md	The nine launch posts with opening frames written, plus the ongoing rotation
../../brand/	Logomark, wordmark, lockup — SVG, scale to any size

Superseded: this previously held a founder/CEO LinkedIn track. You sell to people, not institutions, so it's been removed. It's in git history if you want it back.

Read this first

The brand name **ARÓ** (Yoruba for indigo dye) is my placeholder, not your decision. Anything marked **[CONFIRM]** is my inference from this repository, not a fact you gave me.

The order that actually matters

Most people start with the logo. That's the wrong end. Do this instead:

1. **Decide where it's made** (brand-foundation.md §5). Everything — price, delivery promise, what you can honestly claim — follows from it. The shipping maths is the thing that kills diaspora clothing brands.
2. **Clear the name:** trademark search in class 25, then domain, then handles. Don't print a label until all three pass.
3. **Order samples** of three pieces and approve them.
4. **One photo day.** A friend with a recent phone, natural light, 2 people, neutral backdrop. Target 40 usable shots: flat lays, on-body, motif close-ups. This is the single biggest lever on whether anyone buys.
5. **Set up the shop** (Shopify + Stripe), priced in GBP/USD/CAD with delivery cost visible before checkout.
6. **Bank the nine posts**, then announce.

Realistically: **4–6 weeks to launch** if samples arrive on time, with roughly \$320 lean (print-on-demand only) or ~\$2,000 including a small hand-dyed capsule.

What I need from you

1. **The name** — ARÓ, or yours. Say which and I'll redo the assets and copy.
2. **Which manufacturing route** — print-on-demand, artisan capsule, or both.
3. **Do you have a maker relationship yet?** Post 6 depends on it, and I've written an honest alternative in case you don't.
4. **Your reason for starting** — the real scene, for post 8.
5. **Your market priority** — UK, US, or Canada first. It changes which print partner and which currency leads.

Answer those and I'll finish the copy, price the range against live quotes, and write the product-page story cards.

Targets (from `../playbooks/brand.md`)

DAY	FOLLOWERS	MONTHLY LINK CLICKS	SALES
30	200–500	50–150	pre-launch
60	500–1,500	150–500	first 10–25
90	1,000–3,000	400–1,200	40–80 cumulative

Below these at day 60, check in this order: **photo quality** → **price** → **audience**. It is almost always the photos.

Brand foundation

Replaces the founder/CEO LinkedIn track. That was built on the assumption you sell to institutions; you sell to people, so it's gone. It's in git history if you ever want it back.

Track: Brand · **Platforms:** Instagram + TikTok (same videos on both), Pinterest second · **Buyers:** West African diaspora in the UK, US, Canada · **Time:** 3–5 hrs/week

1. The one fact that should drive your decisions

Shipping from Nigeria to London or New York costs \$40–60 and takes 1–3 weeks.

On a \$60 shirt that's a brand-killer. Your buyer is comparing you to things that arrive in three days. Most diaspora clothing brands die here, not on marketing.

So the first decision isn't a logo. It's **where the garment is made and shipped from**, and it has a clean answer: see \$5.

2. What you're actually selling

Not fabric. The emotional driver for a diaspora buyer is this:

Wearing where you're from on an ordinary Tuesday, without it being a costume.

Most people in the diaspora own something traditional. It comes out at weddings, naming ceremonies, and Christmas. It sits in a wardrobe the other 360 days. The gap in the market is clothing with real heritage in it that you can wear to work, to brunch, to the school run.

Everything you post should serve that sentence.

3. Positioning

For **West Africans abroad** who want to wear their heritage without saving it for occasions, **[BRAND]** makes **everyday clothing in original Adire indigo patterns**, where **every pattern names the technique it comes from and every maker is credited** — unlike generic "African print" sold with no source.

Tagline options (≤7 words): - *Indigo, drawn by hand. Worn every day.* - *Heritage you don't save for Sunday.* - *Not for occasions. For Tuesdays.*

My pick is the third — it's the sharpest version of the actual insight, and it will stop a diaspora scroller mid-feed.

4. The name

[CONFIRM] — **you decide this one.** My draft is **ARÓ**, the Yoruba word for indigo dye. It's short, says what the product is, and is in the language of the craft. Assets in **brand/** use it as a placeholder.

Before you commit to any name, in this order: 1. **Trademark search** in class 25 (clothing): USPTO TESS, UK IPO, and Nigeria's registry. If a live clothing mark exists, rename now — it's cheap today and ruinous later. 2. Domain available (.com plus one alternative). 3. Same handle free on Instagram, TikTok, and Pinterest.

Don't print a single label until all three clear.

5. Where it's made — pick this before anything else

ROUTE	WHERE IT SHIPS FROM	DELIVERY TO BUYER	UNIT COST (EST.)	HONEST LABEL
A. Print-on-demand (Printful, Printify)	Printed in US/UK/EU	3–5 days	Tee ~\$14, all-over shirt ~\$30–40	"Adire-pattern print"
B. Artisan-dyed in Abeokuta	Nigeria, or batch-shipped to you	1–3 weeks, or local once landed	Varies — get 3 quotes	"Hand-dyed Adire"

Recommended: run both, and be loud about the difference.

- **Route A is your everyday range and your cash flow.** It sidesteps the shipping problem entirely, carries no inventory risk, and lets you test which patterns people actually buy before you spend anything.
- **Route B is a small capsule — 10–30 pieces — and it is your credibility.** Real hand-dyed cloth, real named makers, higher price, limited. It's what makes the story true rather than decorative, and it's what press and creators cover.

The honest-labelling rule, non-negotiable: a printed piece is an **"Adire-pattern print."** Only artisan resist-dyed cloth is **"hand-dyed Adire."** Never blur them. Diaspora buyers know the difference, and heritage brands that fudge this get publicly dismantled — deservedly.

6. Pricing (estimates — verify against live quotes)

ITEM	ROUTE	COST + FEES (EST.)	SELL	ROUGH GROSS MARGIN
Tee	A	~\$19	\$45–55	~60%
Camp-collar shirt (all-over)	A	~\$42	\$89–110	~55%
Scarf	A	~\$22	\$45–65	~60%
Hand-dyed capsule shirt	B	varies	\$150–250	set after quotes

Below \$40 on a tee you're working for free once returns, ads, and failed deliveries are counted. Diaspora buyers will pay a premium for a real story — but only if the photos and the site look worth it.

Payments: Shopify + Stripe (cards, Apple Pay, PayPal). Not a Nigerian-only gateway — your buyers are paying in GBP, USD and CAD. Price in the buyer's currency and show delivery cost before checkout.

7. Brand voice

YOU ARE	YOU ARE NOT
Specific: "eleko wax-stamp, 80mm repeat"	Vague: "ethnic-inspired vibes"
Warm, quietly confident	All-caps, "🔥 DROP 🔥"

YOU ARE	YOU ARE NOT
Crediting the craft and the makers	Implying you invented any of it
Plain English, one Yoruba word at a time, explained	Untranslated words used to seem exotic

8. Visual identity

Assets are in `brand/` (placeholder name, swap when yours is confirmed).

COLOUR	HEX	ROLE
Indigo	#1B2A6B	Primary — the dye itself
Bone	#F5EFE0	Undyed cloth; light backgrounds
Rust	#C4622D	Accent only, ≤10% of any layout
Ink	#0F1838	Deep text, dark backgrounds

Indigo on bone measures ~11.5:1 contrast, which passes accessibility standards comfortably. Rust on bone is ~3.6:1, so use it for large text and shapes only, never body copy.

Type: Fraunces (display) + Inter (body), both free on Google Fonts.

9. The product line

Your three existing patterns become the first three products:

PATTERN FILE	TECHNIQUE	PRODUCT
<code>adire-pattern.svg</code>	Stamped double-diamond	Ọ̀nà tee & scarf
<code>adire-pattern-2.svg</code>	<i>Oniko</i> tie-resist circles	Oniko camp-collar shirt
<code>adire-pattern-3.svg</code>	<i>Eleko</i> wax-stamp squares	Eleko shirt

Each product page carries a story card: the technique, what the motif means, and who made it. That card is the whole differentiator — it's the thing no drop-shipper can copy.

10. Cultural responsibility — write this into the business

1. **Credit the source.** Adire is a Yoruba craft centred historically on Abeokuta and Ibadan. Say so on the About page, not in the small print.
2. **Pay makers properly, and say how.** One sentence is enough: "Artisans are paid per piece at an agreed rate before anything goes on sale."
3. **Your patterns are original compositions in the Adire tradition.** Never copy a living artisan's specific design without a licence and credit.
4. When you get it wrong, fix it publicly and fast.

Instagram and TikTok copy

Placeholder name **ARÓ** throughout. Swap once yours clears the three checks in `brand-foundation.md` §4.

Handles

Claim the same one everywhere, even on platforms you won't use yet.

Try in order: `@aro.indigo` · `@wearearo` · `@aro.cloth` · `@arostudio`

Claim on: **Instagram, TikTok, Pinterest, X, YouTube** + the matching domain.

Profile picture

The logomark from `brand/logomark.svg` — the double-diamond on indigo. It reads at 40px, which a photo of cloth does not. Same image on every platform.

Instagram bio (150 characters)

Option 1 — my pick, leads with the insight

Heritage you don't save for Sunday.
Everyday clothing in Adire indigo · Every pattern named, every maker credited
🇬🇧🇺🇸🇨🇦 3–5 day delivery
↓ Shop

Option 2 — leads with the craft

Original Adire indigo patterns, cut as everyday clothing.
Yoruba resist-dye · Makers credited · Ships from UK & US
↓ First drop

Option 3 — shortest

Indigo, drawn by hand. Worn every day.
Adire-pattern clothing · UK/US delivery in 3–5 days
↓

Why delivery is in the bio: your buyer's unspoken objection is "this will take three weeks and cost £40 to ship." Kill it before they ask. This single line will do more for conversion than any caption.

TikTok bio (80 characters)

Adire indigo, made to wear on a Tuesday 🇩🇪→🇬🇧🇺🇸
Shop ↓

Link

One link to the shop. If you use a link hub, **Shop is the first item** — not your newsletter, not your story. Test it on a phone before you announce.

Instagram Highlights (build these before launch)

HIGHLIGHT	COVER	WHAT GOES IN IT
Shop	Logomark	Product shots with prices and the link
Shipping	Plain indigo	Where you ship, cost, how long. Your most-visited highlight.
How it's made	Pattern tile	The craft, the makers, the technique
Reviews	Bone background	Every customer photo and message, with permission
Sizing	Plain indigo	Measurements and fit on real bodies

The pinned grid (first 3 posts stay top of profile)

1. What ARÓ is, in one image and three lines
 2. The hero product, worn
 3. The craft — a stamp going onto cloth
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Shop page essentials

- Price in the buyer's currency (GBP/USD/CAD), with delivery cost shown before checkout
- Each product page has a **story card**: the technique, the motif, who made it
- Say plainly on every listing whether it is "**Adire-pattern print**" or "**hand-dyed Adire**"
- Size guide in both inches and cm, with the model's height and size stated
- A returns policy you can actually honour

The first nine posts

Bank all nine before you announce. Schedule three; keep six in reserve so a busy week can't break the streak.

Most of these are short video. Shoot vertical once, post to Reels, TikTok, and Shorts. You do not need a camera — a recent phone in daylight beats bad studio lighting. The first 1.5 seconds decide whether anyone sees the rest, so the opening frame matters more than everything after it.

[. . .] marks where your real detail goes. A post with my placeholder left in is worse than no post.

1 · What this is

Pillar: product · Format: carousel or single image

Opening frame/line: *Heritage you don't save for Sunday.*

- Image: the hero piece worn in an ordinary setting — a kitchen, a bus stop, a desk. **Not** a studio, and not a wedding.
 - Caption: what ARÓ is in three lines. The pattern's name, the technique it comes from, where it ships from and how fast.
 - Close: *Which pattern would you wear first — Ònà, Oniko, or Eleko?*
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2 · The stamp

*Pillar: behind the scenes · Format: video, 15–25s · your strongest post***

Opening frame: a hand pressing a carved stamp onto plain cloth. No face, no talking, no intro. Just the press.

- Then: the cloth going into indigo, and the moment it oxidises from green to blue as it hits the air. That colour change is the single most watchable thing in this entire craft.
- Text on screen: *This is eleko. The paste blocks the dye. The pattern is what the dye never touched.*
- No voiceover needed. Let it be quiet.

If you can only make one piece of content this month, make this one.

3 · Three ways to wear it

Pillar: product in use · Format: video, 20s

Opening line: *One shirt, three Tuesdays.*

Same piece styled three ways — work, dinner, weekend. Hard cuts on the beat. This is the post that answers "but where would I actually wear it?", which is the real objection stopping the sale.

4 · The shipping answer

Pillar: proof · Format: text-on-image or talking video, 15s

Opening line: *"How long will it take to reach London?" Three to five days.*

- Explain, plainly, that your everyday range is printed in the UK/US and ships locally, which is why it's fast and why there's no customs surprise.
 - Say what the hand-dyed capsule is and why that one takes longer.
 - This post will underperform on likes and overperform on sales. Post it anyway.
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5 · What the pattern means

Pillar: the craft · Format: carousel

Opening frame: extreme close-up of one motif, filling the screen.

Then zoom out, step by step, to the full cloth and the finished garment. Caption explains the motif: [what the double-diamond or the circle means, and why that technique produces it].

Teach one thing. People save posts that taught them something, and saves push reach harder than likes.

6 · The maker

Pillar: the people · Format: video or photo set

[A named artisan, with their permission – their hands, their workshop, their name.]

Say how they're paid. One honest sentence: "Artisans are paid per piece at an agreed rate before anything goes on sale."

If you don't yet have a maker relationship, do not fake this one. Replace it with a post about the tradition itself and where it comes from — Abeokuta, Ibadan, the women who built the craft — and post the maker version when it's real.

7 · Printed vs hand-dyed

Pillar: proof · Format: side-by-side video or carousel

Opening line: One of these was dyed by hand. One was printed. Here's how to tell — and why we say which is which.

Show both. Explain the difference honestly, including that the printed one is a print.

This post does something unusual: it makes you *more* trustworthy by admitting what you don't hand-make. Nobody else in this category does it, and your buyer has absolutely been burned by someone claiming otherwise.

8 · Why you started

Pillar: the human · Format: talking video, 30s, or photo + caption

[Your real reason. A specific scene, not a mission statement – the wardrobe where the good cloth waits for a wedding, the thing someone said, the moment you decided.]

Your face in this one. People buy clothing from people.

9 · The first drop

Pillar: product · your one direct ask of the nine

Opening line: *[N] pieces. [Date]. Here's everything in it.*

What's in the drop, the prices, the sizes, when it opens, how to be first. Link in bio, and say the word "link in bio" out loud in the video — people miss it otherwise.

One hard ask in nine posts. That ratio is what makes the ask land.

After the nine

3–5 posts a week, at least two of them video. Rotation:

WEEK	POST 1	POST 2	POST 3
A	Product in use	Behind the scenes / craft	Proof (review, customer photo)
B	Behind the scenes / craft	Product in use	Value or culture post

Stories daily, low effort: packing an order, a fabric close-up, a poll between two colourways, a question box. Stories are where you build the relationship that the feed converts.

The growth moves that actually matter here

1. **Seed 20 micro-creators** (2k–20k followers, diaspora fashion, slow fashion, African culture accounts) with a free piece. Expect about 1 in 4 to post. That's a normal hit rate, not a failure.
2. **Repost every customer photo**, with permission and credit. Free content, and it's proof.
3. **Pinterest** — upload every product and pattern image. Pins surface for months and years; feed posts die in 48 hours. Highest-leverage hour you'll spend.
4. **Answer every DM.** On a new shop, each DM is a potential sale, and most will be asking about sizing or shipping.
5. **Only boost what already worked.** When a post outperforms organically, put \$5–10/day behind it. Never pay to push a post that failed for free.